PRINTABLE EDITION

The Yooper Dictionary

How we talk up here in Michigan's Upper Peninsula, eh

153 words and sayings, each with a plain meaning and an example

Stick it on the fridge at camp, hand it to the trolls visiting from below the bridge, or settle that argument about pasties once and for all.

2 Broke Yoopers

How to use this dictionary

Words are in A to Z order. Each one gives the word, how to say it when that helps, a plain meaning and a short example. "Also" lists other spellings you might see.

Every word was checked against a real web page that ties it to the U.P. The free online version names the page for every word.

Want the free, searchable version for your phone? Visit 2brokeyoopers.github.io/tools/yooper-dictionary and look up any word in a second, even if you spell it like a troll.

Know a word we missed? Thank you for helping! Please send it to 2brokeyoopers@gmail.com.

# #

906 (nine-oh-six) *n.*
The telephone area code for the whole U.P., used as a proud nickname for it.
"*Born and raised in the 906, and proud of it.*"
Also: da 906, the 906

A

Ahmeek *n.*
A Keweenaw village named from the Ojibwe word amik, meaning beaver.
"*We stopped at Ahmeek to look for beavers.*"

B

bal maiden *n.*
A woman who worked at a Cornish mine.
"*A bal maiden's shout echoed down the shaft.*"

bear roll *n.*
A dance at Hancock's winter festival that everyone is invited to join.
"*Everybody joined the bear roll to warm up in the cold.*"

beater *n.*
An old car or truck that still runs, more or less.
"*My beater has more rust than paint, but it starts every time.*"

Big Gus *n.*
The giant chainsaw at Da Yoopers Tourist Trap near Ishpeming, said to be the world's biggest.
"*We took a picture next to Big Gus.*"

Big Mac *n.*
A nickname for the Mackinac Bridge.
"*The Big Mac looked like a sparkly necklace at night.*"

Boozhoo *interj.*
The Ojibwe word for hello.
"*Boozhoo! Welcome to the powwow!*"

buck pole *n.*
A pole where hunters hang their deer so everyone in town can see them on opening day.
"*Our whole town came to look at the buck pole.*"

bug juice *n.*
Bug spray. Yoopers joke it is the best-selling cologne in the U.P.
"*Pass the bug juice before we hike to the falls.*"

C

cabin fever *n.*
That restless, stuck-inside feeling at the end of a long U.P. winter, just before spring fever.
"*By March, cabin fever had us building a snowman in the living room.*"

Calumet (KAL-yuh-MET) *n.*
A Keweenaw village in the old Copper Country. Locals say it a little differently than outsiders.
"*Calumet gets lots of snow and has an old opera house.*"

camp *n.*
A Yooper's second home, often a cabin in the woods that may or may not have power or running water.
"*No phone signal at camp, so we played cards all weekend.*"

Cheeseheads *n.*
A joking Yooper name for neighbors in Wisconsin, the "banana belt" to the south.
"*The Cheeseheads came across the border for our fish fry.*"

chook (chook, like book) *n.*
A knit winter hat. The word comes from the French-Canadian word toque.
"*Pull your chook down over your ears before you go sledding.*"
Also: chuke, chooks

choppers *n.*
Deerskin mittens with a wool mitten inside. Warmer than gloves.
"*Lost one of my choppers in the snowbank, so now I have one warm hand.*"

Copper Country *n.*
The part of the western U.P. around the Keweenaw where lots of copper was mined.
"*My great-grandpa worked in Copper Country mines.*"

Cousin Jack *n.*
A nickname for Cornish miners who came to work in the Copper Country.
"*Great-grandpa was a Cousin Jack who dug copper near Calumet.*"

Cousin Jennies *n.*
The wives of Cornish miners, who brought saffron buns and the pasty to the U.P.
"*The Cousin Jennies baked saffron buns for Sunday.*"

crib *n.*
A Cornish word for a miner's lunch break, brought to the Copper Country by Cornish miners.
"*The miners stopped for crib and opened their lunch pails.*"

crick *n.*
Yooper way of saying creek, a small stream.
"*Turn left right after da crick.*"

croust *n.*
Another Cornish word for a miner's lunch break, part of Copper Country mining talk.
"*At croust, the team sat down to eat their pasties.*"

cudighi (KOOD-ih-gee) *n.*
A spicy Italian sausage that is a U.P. classic, often linked to Ishpeming.
"*A cudighi sandwich with onions makes a cold day better.*"
Also: cudighis

D

da *art.*
Yooper way of saying "the."
"*Meet me by da lake at sunset.*"

da bridge *n.*
The Mackinac Bridge, which joins the U.P. to the rest of Michigan.
"*We crossed da bridge and everybody in the car cheered.*"
Also: the bridge

da Mitten *n.*
Yooper nickname for the Lower Peninsula, which is shaped like a mitten on a map.
"*Our cousins live down in da Mitten, near the thumb.*"
Also: the mitten

da U.P. (YOO-pee) *n.*
The Upper Peninsula of Michigan. Say the two letters, U and P.
"*We're heading up to da U.P. for blueberry season.*"
Also: the U.P., U.P.

Da Yoopers *n.*
A comedy band from Ishpeming famous for funny songs about U.P. life.
"*Dad sings Da Yoopers songs on every road trip.*"

deer camp *n.*
The hunting cabin in the woods for November deer season, and also the two weeks of that season itself.
"*Uncle Ray has been talking about deer camp since the Fourth of July.*"

deer car *n.*
An older, beat-up car you drive when deer might jump out.
"*We took da deer car on da back road.*"

dis and dat *phr.*
Yoopers often say a D sound for TH, so "this and that" becomes "dis and dat."
"*Dis is da best fish fry in da whole county, eh.*"
Also: dis, dat, den, dem, dose

downstate *adj.*
In the lower part of Michigan, away from the U.P.
"*Our downstate cousins visit every summer for the fishing.*"

E

eh *interj.*
Added to the end of a sentence to mean "right?" or "don't you think?"
"*Nice day for a drive along the lake, eh?*"
Also: eh?

Escanaba (ES-kuh-NAH-buh) *n.*
A port city in the U.P. on Lake Michigan, in Delta County.
"*Grandpa grew up in Escanaba, right on Lake Michigan.*"

Escanaba in da Moonlight *n.*
A funny movie about a family deer camp, filmed near Escanaba, that uses U.P. talk.
"*We watched Escanaba in da Moonlight before deer season.*"

Esky *n.*
Short, friendly nickname for the city of Escanaba in the U.P.
"*Let's meet in Esky for lunch.*"

F

flatlander *n.*
A nickname for someone from the Lower Peninsula.
"*The flatlander had never seen snow that deep in October.*"
Also: flatlanders

fudgie *n.*
A tourist up north, named for all the fudge visitors buy before they go home.
"*The fudgies cleaned out the fudge shop by noon, eh.*"
Also: fudgies, fudgey

G

Gitche Gumee (GITCH-ee GOO-mee) *n.*
Longfellow's spelling of the Ojibwe name for Lake Superior, meaning great sea.
"*The old song calls Lake Superior Gitche Gumee.*"
Also: Gichigami, Gichi-gami, Gitchi Gami

God's Country *n.*
A loving name Yoopers use for the U.P. and its beauty.
"*Fall colors along the lake? Yep, that's God's Country.*"

go store *phr.*
Yoopers often drop "to the," a habit from Finnish, which has no words for "a" or "the."
"*Hold on, I gotta go store for milk and bread.*"
Also: let's go store, go Shopko

Grand Marais (grand muh-RAY) *n.*
A tiny U.P. town on Lake Superior near the Grand Sable Dunes, with a harbor.
"*We watched the waves roll into Grand Marais.*"

Graveyard of the Great Lakes *n.*
A nickname for the stretch of Lake Superior near Whitefish Point where many ships sank.
"*The museum at Whitefish Point tells about the Graveyard of the Great Lakes.*"

H

have a good one *phr.*
The usual friendly goodbye up north.
"*Thanks for the help with the boat, have a good one!*"

Heikinpäivä (HAY-kin-PIE-vah) *n.*
A midwinter festival in Hancock celebrating Finnish culture, with parades, games and the wife-carrying contest.
"*We bundled up for the Heikinpäivä parade in Hancock.*"

Heikki Lunta (HAY-kee LOON-tah) *n.*
The snow god of U.P. folklore, born from Finnish-American Keweenaw culture. Some folks dance to ask him for snow.
"*The snowmobile club did a little dance for Heikki Lunta.*"

hetta *adj.*
Restless, wound up, full of energy. From Finnish.
"*The kids were so hetta on the first snow day they bounced off the walls.*"

holy wah *interj.*
The Yooper way to say "wow!" when something is surprising or amazing.
"*Holy wah, that snowbank is taller than the mailbox!*"
Also: holy wah!, holyowha

Houghton (HOH-tun) *n.*
A Copper Country city on the Keweenaw. The gh is silent, so it sounds like HOH-tun.
"*We drove to Houghton to watch the snow sculptures.*"

I

ihana (EE-hah-nah) *adj.*
Finnish for lovely or wonderful.
"*That sunset over Lake Superior was just ihana.*"

inning *n.*
One round in the sauna, then a cool-off outside.
"*I'll do one more inning, then jump in da lake.*"

Ishpeming (ISH-puh-ming) *n.*
A U.P. iron-mining city in Marquette County, home of Da Yoopers.
"*Ishpeming has a ski jump and a great tourist trap.*"

J

Jampot *n.*
A bakery in Eagle Harbor, run by monks, that sells thimbleberry jam in the Keweenaw.
"We bought a jar of jam at the Jampot."

Juhannus *n.*
The Finnish Midsummer holiday on the longest day of the year, celebrated with fire, sauna and community.
"We watched the Juhannus bonfire glow late into the long evening."

Juhannus salko *n.*
The Midsummer pole, dressed with birch boughs and greens, raised each year on Quincy Green in Hancock.
"We hung birch boughs on the Juhannus salko."

K

kala mojakka *n.*
A Finnish fish stew made in the U.P.
"Nothing warms you up after ice fishing like a bowl of kala mojakka."
Also: kala mojaka, mojakka

Keweenaw (KEE-wuh-naw) *n.*
The northern peninsula that sticks out into Lake Superior, famous for copper and snow.
"The Keweenaw gets so much snow that kids ski to school."

kibble *n.*
A bucket used to haul rock up out of a Copper Country mine.
"The kibble rose slowly up the shaft."

kicksled *n.*
A Finnish sled you push along standing on one runner, raced by kids at Keweenaw winter festivals.
"We raced our kicksleds across the snowy Quincy Green."

kiitos (KEE-tohs) *interj.*
Finnish for "thank you," still heard in Keweenaw families.
"Kiitos for the coffee and the cardamom bread!"

kippo *n.*
The wooden ladle used to pour water on hot sauna rocks.
"Hand me da kippo and I'll make some steam."

Kitch-iti-kipi *n.*
A big clear spring near Manistique whose Ojibwe name means big cold spring.
"We rode the raft over Kitch-iti-kipi and saw the bubbling sand."

kokko *n.*
A big Midsummer bonfire; one has been lit at Toivola's Agate Beach since the 1890s.
"The kokko at Agate Beach lit up the whole shoreline."

korppu *n.*
A twice-baked, crunchy Finnish bread, like the cinnamon toast made in Trenary, for dunking in coffee.
"Dunk your korppu in hot cocoa and it gets soft."

Kuparisaari *n.*
Finnish name meaning copper island, used for the northern half of the Keweenaw Peninsula.
"Grandpa told stories about Kuparisaari, where his family first settled."

L

lake-effect snow *n.*
Heavy snow made when cold wind picks up moisture from a warm lake, like Lake Superior.
"Lake-effect snow buried the Keweenaw again last night."

L'Anse (LAHNSS) *n.*
A village in Baraga County on Keweenaw Bay. The s at the end is said, as in lance.
"We went ice fishing near L'Anse."

lats *n.*
Skis, often homemade ones. From Finnish.
"*Grandma still has the old wooden lats hanging in the garage.*"

Les Cheneaux *n.*
A chain of islands in the eastern U.P. whose French name means the channels.
"*We kayaked around Les Cheneaux all afternoon.*"

lopers *n.*
Another U.P. nickname for people from the Lower Peninsula.
"*The lopers waved at us from the rest stop.*"

löyly *n.*
The hot steam you make by tossing water on the sauna rocks.
"*Hang onto your hat when somebody throws more löyly on the rocks!*"

M

Mackinac (MAK-uh-naw) *n.*
The island and straits between the two peninsulas. It is spelled with c but said like Mackinaw.
"*Say Mackinac like MAK-uh-naw and everyone will smile.*"

make wood *phr.*
To cut and split logs for firewood.
"*We have to make wood all Saturday so the stove stays happy all winter.*"
Also: making wood

makkara (MUCK-ah-dah) *n.*
Finnish word for sausage, used by Finnish families in the U.P.
"*We roasted makkara over the fire at camp.*"

Manistique (man-iss-TEEK) *n.*
A small U.P. city on Lake Michigan in Schoolcraft County.
"*We stopped in Manistique to walk the lakeshore.*"

manoomin *n.*
The Ojibwe word for wild rice, a grain that grows on water.
"*We learned how manoomin is harvested at the wild rice camp.*"

manoominator *n.*
A machine that speeds up winnowing wild rice at the Keweenaw Bay rice camp.
"*The manoominator finished the winnowing much faster.*"

Marquette (mar-KET) *n.*
The biggest city in the U.P., on Lake Superior. The last syllable is KET, not KAY.
"*Marquette is where we go for the big hospital and the big park.*"

Marquette Iron Range *n.*
The famous iron ore deposit around Ishpeming and Negaunee in the U.P.
"*Iron from the Marquette Iron Range went to build ships.*"

Menominee (muh-NOM-uh-nee) *n.*
A city in the southern U.P. on the Wisconsin border.
"*Menominee sits right across the river from Wisconsin.*"

Mighty Mac *n.*
Another nickname for the Mackinac Bridge.
"*The wind was blowing hard, but the Mighty Mac stood strong.*"

Miigwech *interj.*
The Ojibwe word for thank you.
"*Miigwech for sharing your story!*"

Munising (MEW-nuh-sing) *n.*
A U.P. town on Lake Superior, where boats leave for the Pictured Rocks.
"*We rode a boat from Munising to see the cliffs.*"

N

Negaunee *n.*
A U.P. town whose name comes from an Ojibwe word for leading or being in front.
"*We cheered at the Negaunee game.*"

nisu *n.*
A sweet Finnish bread flavored with cardamom, often eaten with coffee.
"*Grandma baked nisu, and we ate it warm after sauna.*"

noseeums *n.*
Tiny biting gnats so small you can hardly see them.
"*The noseeums found us the minute we sat down by the campfire.*"
Also: no-see-ums

O

oggy *n.*
A Cornish word for a pasty, shouted down mine shafts at lunchtime.
"*Mom packed an oggy for my lunch.*"

Old Reliable *n.*
Nickname of the Quincy Mine in the Copper Country, which paid its investors every year for a long time.
"*The tour guide called the Quincy Mine Old Reliable.*"

Ontonagon (ON-tuh-NAH-gun) *n.*
A village in the western U.P. on Lake Superior.
"*Ontonagon is a quiet town by the big lake.*"

ope *interj.*
A quick little "oops" or "excuse me" when you bump into something.
"*Ope, let me just squeeze past ya to get the ketchup.*"

opening day *n.*
The first day of rifle deer season, a big day up north. Some schools even close.
"*The whole town was quiet on opening day because everyone was in the woods.*"
Also: opener

P

pank *v.*
To pat or pack something down, like snow, so it is firm.
"*Pank the snow down good or your fort will fall over.*"
Also: pank it, panked

pannukakku *n.*
A Finnish oven pancake, puffy and custardy.
"*Pannukakku with raspberry jam is the best Sunday breakfast.*"

pasty (PASS-tee) *n.*
A folded pie crust stuffed with meat, potato, rutabaga and onion. A U.P. favorite brought by Cornish miners. Say PASS-tee.
"*One warm pasty in your coat pocket and you are set till supper.*"
Also: pasties, pastie

Pictured Rocks *n.*
Tall colorful sandstone cliffs on Lake Superior near Munising, a national lakeshore.
"*We took a boat tour to see the Pictured Rocks.*"

Plaidurday *n.*
A U.P. holiday for wearing plaid, held the first Friday of October.
"*Wear your best flannel shirt tomorrow, it's Plaidurday!*"

Porkies *n.*
Friendly nickname for the Porcupine Mountains in the western U.P., a big wild park near Lake Superior.
"*We hiked the Porkies to see Lake of the Clouds.*"

portage *v.*
To carry a canoe over land between waterways, as the voyageurs did in the Keweenaw.
"*We had to portage the canoe around the rapids.*"

pre'neer *adv.*
"Pretty near," meaning almost or very close.
"*We're pre'neer to camp, just one more two-track.*"
Also: pretty near, preneer

Presque Isle *n.*
A French place name meaning almost an island, found on the U.P. map.
"*We hiked out to Presque Isle to see the waves.*"

puuroa (BOO-doh-ah) *n.*
Finnish word Keweenaw families use for hot oatmeal porridge.
"*A bowl of puuroa with brown sugar keeps you warm all morning.*"
Also: puuro

R

rezzu *adj.*
Messy or scruffy looking. From the Finnish for "rag boy."
"*Change those rezzu jeans before we go see Grandma.*"

Rootbeer Falls *n.*
Another name for Tahquamenon Falls, because the water looks golden-brown like root beer.
"*We stood at Rootbeer Falls and took a family photo.*"

S

saffron cake *n.*
A golden Cornish cake or bread flavored with saffron, served at Cornish picnics.
"*Aunt Jean brought saffron cake to the picnic.*"

sauna (SOW-nuh) *n.*
A small hot steam room from Finland. In the U.P. you say SOW-nuh, not SAW-nuh.
"*After sauna we rolled in the snow and laughed like crazy.*"

Say ya to da U.P., eh! *phr.*
A famous Yooper motto on mugs, shirts and bumper stickers.
"*Our truck has a bumper sticker that says Say ya to da U.P., eh!*"
Also: Say yah to dah U.P. eh

shut the lights *phr.*
A way of saying turn off the lights.
"*Shut the lights when you leave camp, hey.*"

side by each *phr.*
Yooper way of saying "side by side."
"*We sat side by each on the dock and watched the sunset.*"

sisu (SEE-soo) *n.*
A Finnish word for grit and never giving up. Yoopers say you need it to get through winter.
"*Shoveling the driveway three times in one day takes real sisu.*"

skeetoes *n.*
Mosquitoes. A joke calls them the U.P.'s native bird because they come out by the thousands.
"*The skeetoes are so big this year they need their own fishing license.*"
Also: skeeters, skeetoes

sled *n.*
A snowmobile.
"*I hafta fix my sled before da first snow.*"

sledneck *n.*
Someone who loves riding snowmobiles.
"*Da sledneck zoomed past our cabin, waving.*"

smelt dipping *n.*
A spring sport where people scoop small silvery fish from streams at night with long-handled nets.
"*Smelt dipping with flashlights was my favorite spring night.*"

snowbelt *n.*
A place downwind of a big lake that gets huge piles of lake-effect snow, like parts of the U.P.
"*The Keweenaw is the snowiest snowbelt around.*"

Sorels *n.*
A brand of warm winter boots so common in the U.P. that the name stands for good winter boots.
"*Lace up your Sorels, we're going to watch the snowplow go by.*"

stamp mill *n.*
A big building where heavy hammers crushed rock to pull the copper out.
"*The stamp mill by the lake is now a quiet landmark.*"

stamp sand *n.*
Black or gray sand left over after crushing copper ore in old mills.
"*The beach near the old mill is covered with stamp sand.*"

St. George's Day *n.*
April 23, a Cornish holiday with parades and concerts in Copper Country towns.
"*We went to the St. George's Day concert in Calumet.*"

St. Ignace (IG-nuss) *n.*
A city at the north end of the Mackinac Bridge, where you first land in the U.P.
"*We got fudge in St. Ignace right after the bridge.*"

stope *n.*
A mining method for removing ore, and a Cornish word still used in mines.
"*The crew worked in the stope all day.*"

Stormy Kromer *n.*
A wool cap with fold-down ear flaps, the most popular winter hat in the U.P.
"*Grandpa won't leave the house without his red Stormy Kromer.*"

stump jumper *n.*
An off-road buggy for the bush, or a Yooper who works in the woods.
"*The stump jumper bounced down the trail to the berry patch.*"

St. Urho's Day *n.*
March 16, a playful Finnish-American holiday honoring a saint who chased grasshoppers away to save the grapes.
"*We wore purple on St. Urho's Day to cheer for the grapes.*"

swampers *n.*
Boots with rubber bottoms and leather tops for mud and slush, so you wear them most of the year.
"*Spring in the U.P. means swampers by the door and mud on the porch.*"

T

Tahquamenon (tuh-KWAH-muh-non) *n.*
The name of a U.P. river and falls; nobody is sure what the word first meant.
"*The Tahquamenon Falls looked like root beer rushing over the edge.*"

the Soo (Soo) *n.*
Short name for Sault Ste. Marie, home of the Soo Locks. Sault is said "Soo."
"*Let's drive to the Soo and watch a giant freighter go through the locks.*"
Also: Soo, Sault, Sault Ste. Marie

the Yoop *n.*
A short, friendly nickname for the U.P.
"*Nothing beats a summer night in the Yoop.*"
Also: da Yoop

thimbleberry *n.*
A soft wild berry made into jam in the Keweenaw.
"*Grandma made thimbleberry jam for our toast.*"

Toivo and Eino *n.*
Two Finnish names for the lovable, mixed-up characters in a whole family of Yooper jokes.
"Did you hear the one where Toivo and Eino try to ice fish in July?"
Also: Eino and Toivo, Toivo, Eino

Trenary Toast *n.*
Crunchy cinnamon toast from the town of Trenary, a Finnish twice-baked bread made for dunking in coffee.
"Dunk your Trenary Toast in coffee and listen to the crunch."
Also: Trenary

troll *n.*
A friendly nickname for someone from Michigan's Lower Peninsula, because they live "under the bridge."
"Our troll cousins drove up for the weekend and loved every minute."

tull *n.*
An old-style hard mining hat made of thick felt and resin.
"His tull kept his head safe underground."

two-track *n.*
A narrow dirt road with two wheel ruts, found all over the woods.
"We bumped down a two-track to find the lake."

U

uff da *interj.*
A Scandinavian way to say "oh my!" for surprise, tiredness or relief.
"Uff da, that was a lot of snow to shovel."

UP200 *n.*
A famous sled dog race from Marquette to Grand Marais and back, held each winter.
"We cheered for the sled dogs at the UP200 in Marquette."
Also: U.P. 200

Upper Hand *n.*
A nickname for the U.P. Hold your left hand over your right and the top hand is the U.P.
"Point to the Upper Hand and show us where camp is."

V

vihta *n.*
A bundle of birch twigs used to gently brush the skin in a sauna; also called vasta.
"Uncle Toivo soaked the vihta in water before our sauna."

voyageur *n.*
A French-Canadian boatman who carried goods and people between fur trading posts.
"The voyageur paddled his canoe across Lake Superior."

W

wife-carrying contest *n.*
A silly race at Hancock's winter festival where one person carries another through an obstacle course.
"Mom and Dad trained all week for the wife-carrying contest."

Y

ya *interj.*
"Yes." From the German and Scandinavian word ja.
"Ya, we'll be there by supper."
Also: yah, ja

yah, eh? *phr.*
Yooper for "I know, right?"
"Best pasty you ever had? Yah, eh?"
Also: ya eh

yah hey *interj.*
"No way! You're kidding me!"
"You caught a walleye that big? Yah hey!"
Also: yah sure hey, ya hey

yeah, no *phr.*
A polite Michigan way to answer. The last word is the real answer, so "yeah, no" means no and "no, yeah" means yes.
"Swim in Lake Superior in April? Yeah, no."
Also: ya no, yeah no, no yeah, no, yeah

yet *adv.*
Used to mean "still," as in "I need to clean this room yet."
"I gotta shovel da walk yet before supper."

Yoopanese *n.*
A joking name for the way Yoopers talk, also called Yooper English.
"After one week at camp my cousin was fluent in Yoopanese."

Yooper (YOO-per) *n.*
A person from Michigan's Upper Peninsula. The name comes from the letters U.P.
"Grandpa says you can take a Yooper out of the woods, but he will find his way back."

Yooper Cologne *n.*
Bug spray used to fight U.P. mosquitoes.
"Better dab on some Yooper Cologne before the campfire."

Yooperland *n.*
A fun name for the U.P. itself.
"Welcome to Yooperland, where the snow is deep and the people are friendly."

Yooperlite (YOO-per-lite) *n.*
A gray rock from the U.P. shoreline that glows orange under a UV flashlight.
"We found a Yooperlite on the beach after dark."

Yooper Scooper *n.*
A giant snow shovel made for deep U.P. snow.
"Dad grabbed the Yooper Scooper and cleared da whole driveway."

Yooper talk *n.*
The way people speak in the U.P., with its own sounds, words and sayings.
"Spend a summer in Marquette and you'll pick up Yooper talk fast."

you betcha *phr.*
"Yes, for sure!" A happy, no-doubt-about-it yes.
"Want a second piece of thimbleberry pie? You betcha!"
Also: youbetcha

youse *pron.*
"You" when talking to more than one person, like "you guys."
"Are youse coming to the fish fry Friday?"
Also: youse guys, you'se guys

Thanks for reading, and have a good one!

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